

Research Report

Senior Citizen Mobile Banking

Dashboard, Maker Checker, Fund Transfer



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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Research Goal

The study aims to test the usability of the proposed Senior Dashboard. This included evaluating how seniors respond to structural UI changes, navigate unfamiliar banking concepts (Maker-Checker), and react to system-level friction like authentication and hidden menus.

1. Assess seniors' comfort with the proposed Senior Dashboard and its simplified interface.
2. Explore how seniors understand and adapt to new banking concepts and changes in information architecture.
3. Identify usability barriers that affect navigation, discoverability, and task completion.
4. Understand how authentication requirements and hidden navigation influence trust, confidence, and willingness to use the experience.

Research Methodology & Scale of Study

We conducted in-depth, 1-on-1 in-person qualitative usability tests with 9 participants, utilizing a clickable prototype with interview sessions that ranged from 40 mins to 1 hour and 25 mins.

Team Size

05

Total Team members

1 UX Researcher

4 Designers

Scale

09

Participants

Friends & family + 2 sessions at Axis Bank branches

Engagement

~10

Interview Hours

Sessions ranged from 40 minutes to 1 hour 25 minutes per participant

Participant Demographics

Sr.No	Name	Age	Gender	Place	Primary Bank	Place Of Study	Primary Banking Mode	App Proficiency / Independence	Researcher/ Interviewer	Interview Duration	Task Completion
1	Farooque Shaikh	66	Male	Mumbai	Punjab National bank	Neighbourhood	Branch First	Independent	Saad	1 hr 10 mins	All Tasks Completed
2	Parasuraman	64	Male	Mumbai	Federal bank	Neighbourhood	Branch First	Independent	Saad	1 hr 25 mins	All Tasks Completed
3	Huma Farooque	60	Female	Mumbai	Punjab National bank	Neighbourhood	Branch First	Independent	Saad	~1 hr 10 mins	All Tasks Completed
4	Srimati R	73	Female	Thane	Punjab National bank	Neighbourhood	Branch First	Independent	Sparsha	55 mins*	* not all tasks were completed
5	S. Uchil	60	Male	Mumbai	SBI	Neighbourhood	Branch First	Independent	Saad	~ 1 hr 10 mins	All Tasks Completed
6	Sumita S	64	Female	Mumbai	Canara	Neighbourhood	Mobile App First	Independent	Siddartha	~ 50 mins	* not all tasks were completed
7	Tej Kumar Vaid	81	Male	Gurgaon	Axis	Axis Bank Branch	Branch First	Assisted	Parul	~ 1 hr 15 mins	* not all tasks were completed
8	DD Phadke	70	Male	Badlapur	Axis	Axis Bank Branch	Branch First	Independent	Saad	~ 40 mins	Completed 1A-5A
9	Punita Sinha	60	Female	Patna	ICICI	Neighbourhood	Branch First	Independent	Sakshi	1 hr 5 mins	Completed 1A-5B

Key Themes & Baseline Behaviours

Tech Literacy Baseline

This cohort demonstrates **decent digital proficiency**, with few users **navigating complex lifestyle apps independently**.

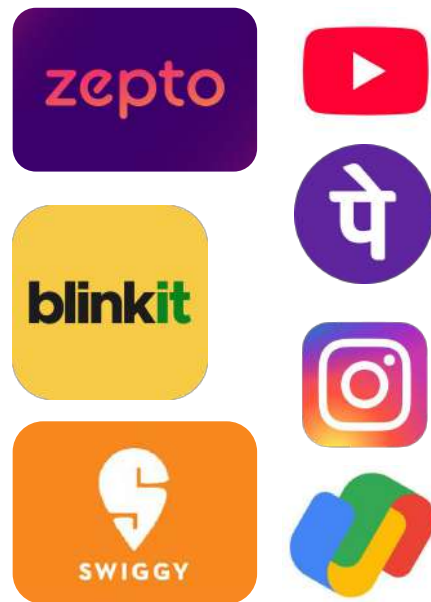
Their hesitation with digital banking stems from a **fear of irreversible financial errors**, not a lack of technical capability.

"I don't use apps for payments. I feel I will make a mistake... I physically withdraw cash."

- 81 y.o User, Gurgaon

"At times due to my age, I enter the wrong pin... due to forgetfulness or typos."

- 70 y.o. User, Badlapur



COMMONLY USED APPS BY THE COHORT

Easy to Read, Not Always Easy to Use

The core UI modifications of **Easy Mode** have shown to be well received: larger text and reduced clutter universally eliminated visual strain.

- However, the system mechanics on the app completely clash with their mental models.
- Navigation conventions like **hamburger menus, disabled icons, and abstract jargon create heavy cognitive load.**
- Despite this, seniors are **surprisingly forgiving of extra clicks if they believe the friction makes their banking safer.**

"Perfect... very easy to read, less clutter."

- 66 y.o. User, Mumbai

"Will have to use daily.. otherwise I will forget."

- 70 y.o. User, Badlapur

Where the Experience Works, & Where It Breaks

What Worked

Zoomed-in Typography: Immediately improved scanning speed.

Explicit Text Labels: "Show Amount" text vastly outperformed abstract "Eye" icons.

Contextual Onboarding: Showing "Easy Mode" at pre-login completely removed anxiety about lock-in.

*"Looks like settings...I saw it long back once...I don't know these and they are of no use..so I don't come here"
(Hamburger Menu)*

- 70 y.o. User, Badlapur

Observed Friction

The Hamburger Menu: Invisible to this demographic; viewed as a 'dusty closet' for unused settings.

UI Authentication: Asking for Aadhaar/Debit verification just to turn on a UI feature triggered heavy distrust.

Jargon Blindness: Terms like "Standard Mode" or "Payee" hold no contextual meaning for some.

"But is it Necessary?" (Choosing between AADHAR & Debit Card)

- 60 y.o. User, Mumbai

Users Trust Familiar Safeguards More

Seniors do not necessarily rely on standard system-level security for peace of mind.

- They invent their own safeguards. Eg. sending ₹1 test transfers.
- When the app tries to introduce new safety features, like Maker-Checker workflows or sudden cautionary Fraud warnings it often, triggers anxiety.
- To them this UI resembles an error penalty or a daily spending cap rather than a protective net.

"Perfect... very easy to read, less clutter."

- 66 y.o. User, Mumbai

"Will have to use daily.. otherwise I will forget."

- 70 y.o. User, Badlapur

Digital Friction Quickly Pushes Users Offline

Third-party payment applications serve as the absolute default for daily transactions across this demographic. Traditional banking apps (that they currently use), conversely, suffer from a deep-rooted reputation for poor reliability.

- Whenever digital friction occurs, users immediately revert to physical channels.
- Abandoning the interface entirely and visiting a local branch is the standard protocol for confusing flows or high-stakes transfers.
- Furthermore, even when using apps successfully as read-only ledgers, they inherently distrust digital records and demand printed passbooks as tangible proof of their money.

"My PNB app does not work... I do all my payments using Amazon Pay UPI."

- 60 y.o. User, Mumbai

"If I don't understand, I visit the branch."

- 64 y.o. User, Mumbai

Deep Dive-Usability Tasks 1-6

Task 1

- **Scenario**
Explore the dashboard, check balance, and verify recent transactions.
- **Objective**
Evaluate dashboard usability, balance visibility, and transaction discoverability.
- **Observe**
Navigation, discoverability, hesitation, and task completion confidence.

Task 1A

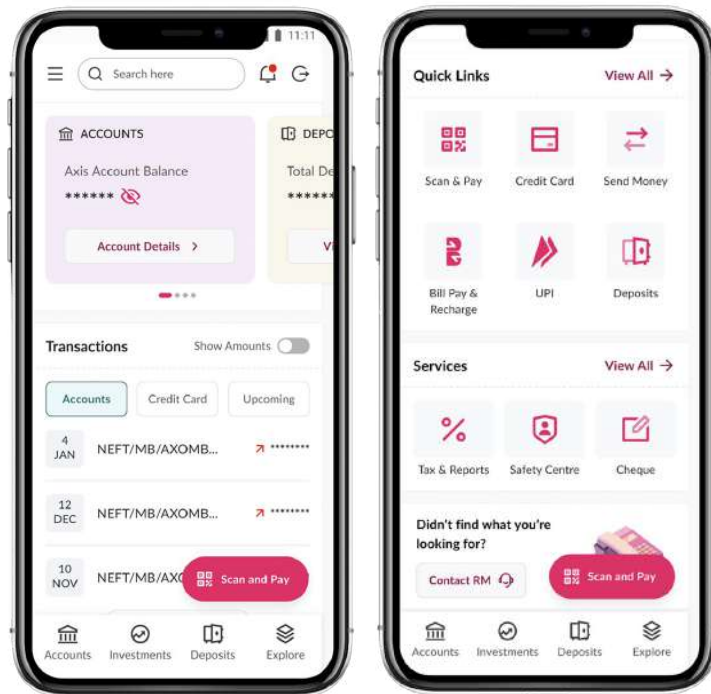
Users Find the Simpler Layout Easier to Navigate

Stripping away distractions and enlarging typography significantly lowers cognitive load.

- Users demonstrated a visible shift in behavior before it even registered in their awareness.
- They paused less and scanned faster.
- This cleaner layout maps perfectly to the mental models of third-party payment apps they already trust.

Field Observation: The user did not realize the new prototype was a 'zoomed-in' version until explicitly prompted. His scanning pauses drastically reduced on the new prototype because there were fewer elements to process.

— Observed in a 70 y.o. user from Badlapur



USERS SCANNING THE EASY MODE DASHBOARD WITH REDUCED COGNITIVE LOAD.

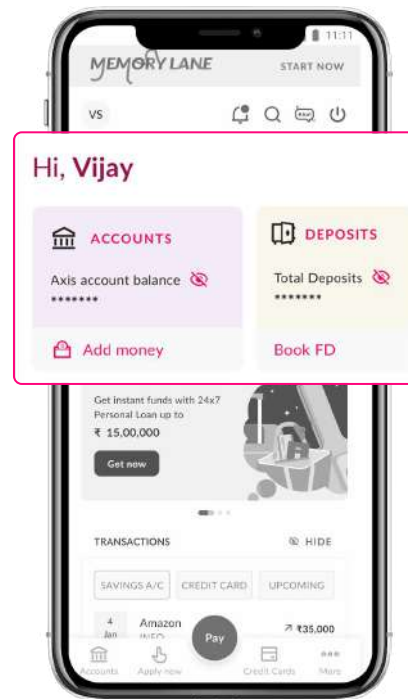
Personalisation Reinforces a Sense of Security

Personalisation is not just a friendly UX writing touch for this demographic; it serves as a critical visual anchor.

- Observant users immediately flag a missing personalized greeting because it acts as direct confirmation that they have safely entered their own private, authenticated account.

Field Observation: The user noticed the missing 'Hi [Name]' immediately, indicating it acts as visual confirmation that the user is safely logged into their own account.

— Observed in multiple users from Mumbai



THE "HI, [NAME]" GREETING ACTING AS VISUAL CONFIRMATION OF A SECURE LOGIN

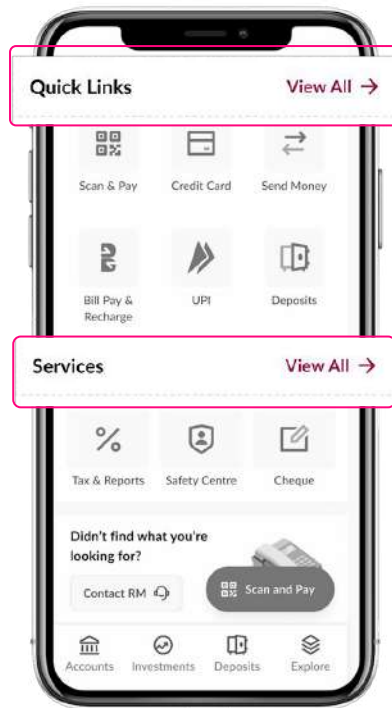
Users Aren't Sure What a Simplified Dashboard Leaves Out

Hiding everyday tools behind a "View All" button causes friction that scales with tech literacy.

- Cautious users worry the application has permanently lost capabilities.
- However, independent, tech-savvy users expect the simplified interface to either be algorithmically curated to their habits or allow manual pinning of favorites.

Field Observation: With the reduced icon set on the prototype, the user incorrectly assumed the app was automatically curating a "frequently used" list specifically for him, comparing it to YouTube algorithms.

— Observed in a 60 y.o. male user from Mumbai (User 5). Divergent reactions to hidden icons were noted across 4 users.



CAUTIOUS USERS QUESTIONING WHAT CAPABILITIES ARE HIDDEN BEHIND THE VIEW ALL MENU.

Task 1B

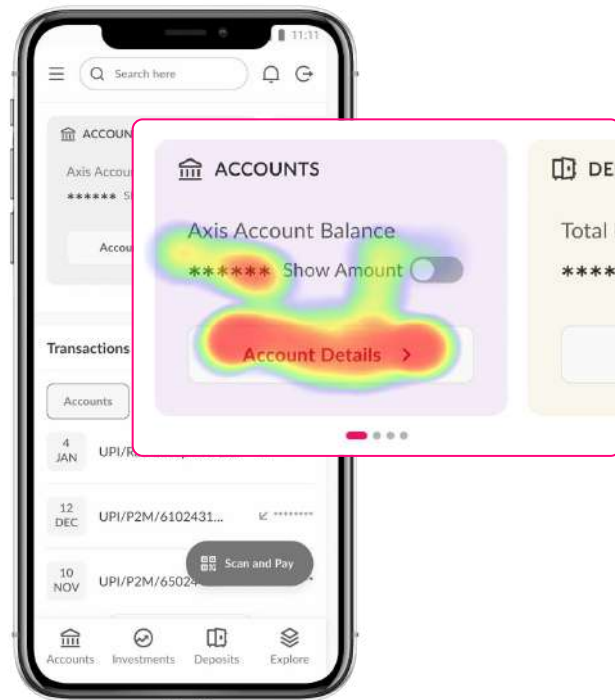
Users Look for the Most Obvious Place to Tap

Users bypass dedicated show/hide controls and aim for the most obvious, broad tap target.

- Because the **Account Details** tile visually resembles a primary button, their mental model defaults to tapping the largest relevant area.
- Small, isolated icons are ignored during task-oriented focus.

Field Observation: The user completely missed that the balance was hidden at first. He fell into the trap of aggressively tapping "Account Details" and only found the toggle by blindly tapping around the screen.

— Observed in an 81 y.o. male user from Gurgaon (User 7). This behavior of choosing the most obvious tap target over precision icons was seen in 6 users.



USERS AGGRESSIVELY TARGETING THE LARGE "ACCOUNT DETAILS" TILE WHILE MISSING SMALLER ICONS.

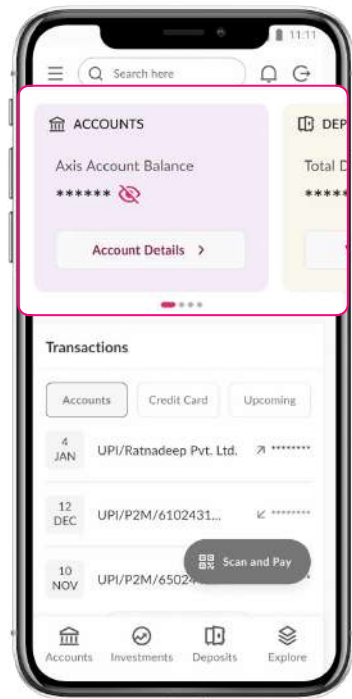
The Eye Icon Doesn't Clearly Signal Show Amount

Seniors do not want to decode abstract UI symbols.

- The "Eye" icon carries a strong password association, triggering anxiety when applied to an account balance.
- Explicit text labels combined with direct interaction perform the best.

Field Observation: The "eye" icon meant absolutely nothing to her. She successfully navigated the task strictly by reading the explicit "Show Amount" text or clicking "Account Details," completely ignoring the visual symbology.

— Observed in a 64 y.o. female user from Mumbai (User 6). The strong password association with the eye icon was noted across 5 cautious users.



THE ABSTRACT EYE ICON TRIGGERING PASSWORD ASSOCIATIONS RATHER THAN REVEALING THE BALANCE.

Users Expect the Same Interaction They Already Know

Users expect direct interaction over indirect system controls.

- Their muscle memory dictates that they should just tap the hidden asterisks (***) directly to reveal the numbers, rather than looking for a separate control mechanism elsewhere on the screen.

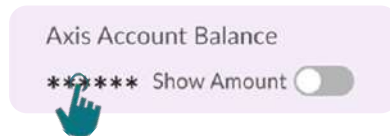
Field Observation: The user completely ignored both the toggle and the eye icon. His mental model is **permanently mapped to the current live app**, where the tap area is much bigger & you tap the asterisks directly to reveal the amount.

— Observed in a 70 y.o. male user from Badlapur (User 8). This "direct tap" behavior was noted across 3 users.

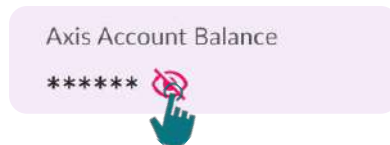
MOST PREFERRED



SECONDARY



IGNORED



COMPARISON OF THE PRIMARY CARD BUTTON, INLINE TOGGLE, AND MASKED EYE ICON.

Task 1C

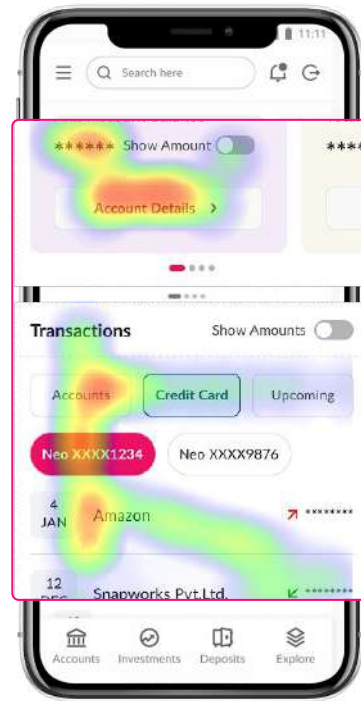
Users Do Not Naturally Recognise Card-Level Separation

While finding the main "Credit Card" section is generally successful, the UI separating multiple credit cards completely fails.

- Users ignore or do not understand the sub-tabs.
- Their mental model expects either a unified feed of all credit activity or explicitly distinct visual grouping (like color-coding).

Field Observation: The user assumed the tab would just aggregate cards from other banks, completely missing the sub-tab navigation meant to separate multiple Axis credit cards.

— Observation noted across 5 users



USERS COMPLETELY MISSING THE HORIZONTAL SUB-TAB NAVIGATION FOR MULTIPLE CREDIT CARDS.

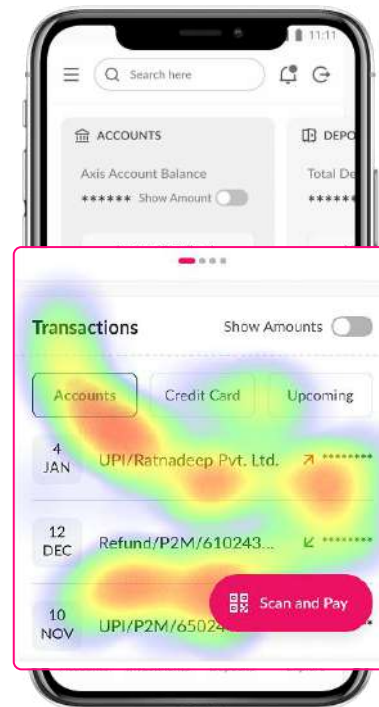
Users' Interaction Follows the Information, Not the Control

Masking data without providing context breaks comprehension.

- If the primary data (the money) is hidden, the surrounding UI icons lose their meaning.
- Just like the 'balance' screen, users instinctually try to directly tap the masked asterisks to fix this rather than looking for a toggle.

Field Observation: The concept of masked amounts was deeply unfamiliar and confusing. The red and green arrows meant absolutely nothing to her until she finally figured out how to reveal the actual amounts.

— Observed in a 60 y.o. female user from Patna and 3 other users.



USERS COMPLETELY MISSING THE HORIZONTAL SUB-TAB NAVIGATION FOR MULTIPLE CREDIT CARDS.

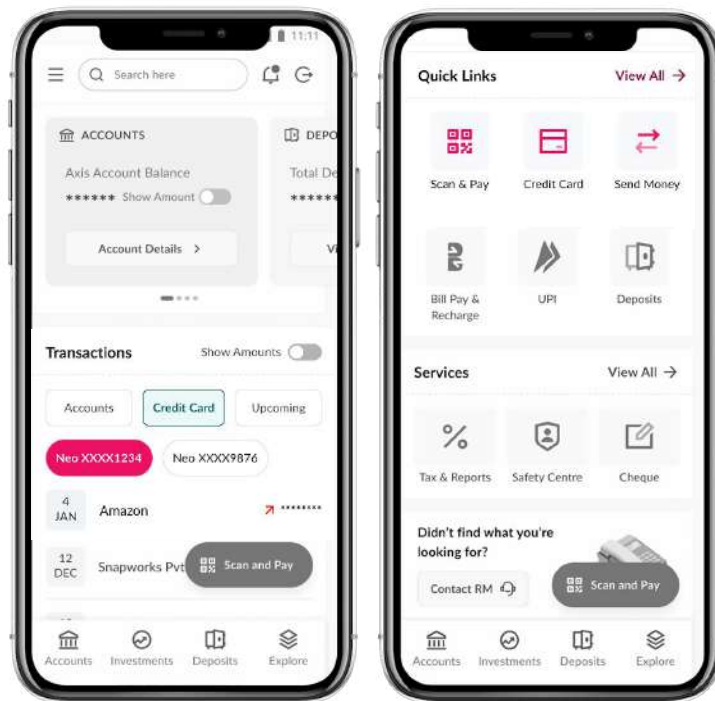
Users Take Different Paths to Find Credit Card Transactions

There is a mental model divide regarding where a Credit Card transaction lives for these users.

- Half the users look for it under the chronological Transactions ledger, while the other half immediately scroll up to Quick Links, treating the Credit Card as a separate, standalone product module.

Field Observation: The user didn't look for Credit Card transactions under the dedicated "Transactions" tab at all. Instead, she immediately expected to find the credit card housed under the "Quick Links" section.

— Observed in a 64 y.o. female user from Mumbai. This divide was noted across 3 users.



USERS SPLITTING BETWEEN "QUICK LINKS" AND "TRANSACTIONS" TO FIND CREDIT CARD HISTORY.

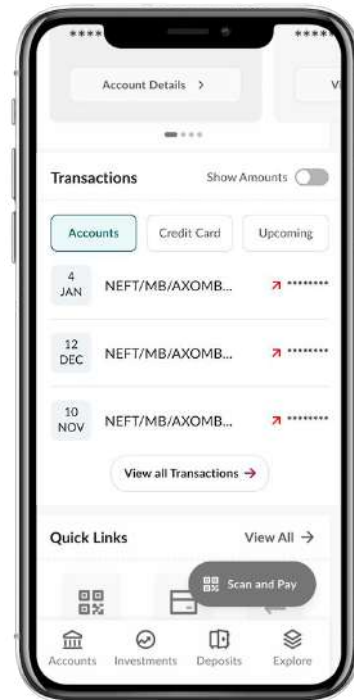
Users Expect Individual Transactions to be Interactive

The transaction ledger is not seen as just a read-only list; it is expected to be an interactive element/gateway.

- Users naturally tap on individual transaction line items, fully expecting them to expand or open into a detailed, itemized receipt view.

Field Observation: After successfully using the toggle, the user immediately tried to tap an individual transaction line item, expecting it to expand into a detailed digital receipt.

— Observed in a 60 y.o. female user from Mumbai (User 3). Expected interactivity was noted across 3 users.



USERS ATTEMPTING TO TAP INDIVIDUAL TRANSACTION LINE ITEMS TO VIEW DETAILED RECEIPTS.

Task 2

- **Scenario**
Add a new payee, search and pay to people
- **Objective**
Evaluate dashboard usability, balance visibility, and transaction discoverability.
- **Observe**
Navigation, discoverability, hesitation, and task completion confidence.

Task 2A

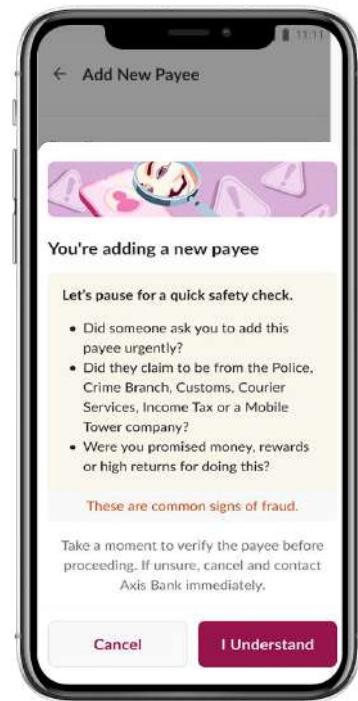
Users Welcome an Extra Check Before Adding a Payee

Explicit safety warnings inserted before adding a payee are highly effective. Rather than causing frustration, they act as intentional, welcomed friction.

- They force reflection and provide a tangible sense of safety, proving that this demographic actively wants the system to slow them down during high-stakes actions.

Field Observation: The user perfectly articulated the purpose of the safety warning, calling it a "speed breaker telling me to take a moment and reflect."

— Observed in a 60 y.o. male user from Mumbai. Positive reception to this warning was also clearly vocalized by 3 other Users.



THE PRE-PAYEE FRAUD WARNING ACTING AS AN APPRECIATED SPEED BREAKER.

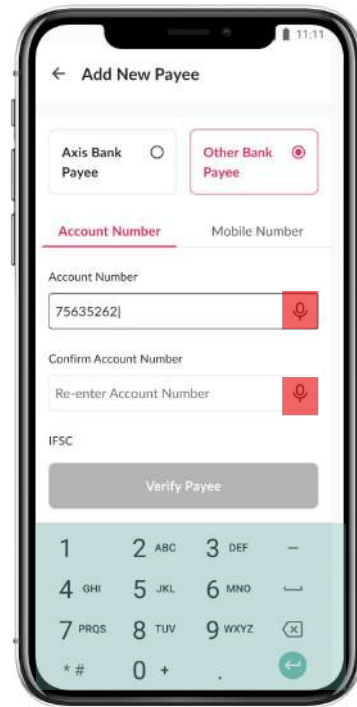
Users Are More Comfortable Typing Than Speaking

Users reject voice input for banking tasks. It is viewed as an unfamiliar mechanic at best, and an active security threat at worst and they would never use it because they refuse to speak financial details aloud.

- While seniors might happily use voice search on YouTube, they actively reject it in a banking context as it is overwhelmingly perceived as a severe privacy risk and a vector for theft.
- They strongly prefer the manual friction of typing via the physical number pad to ensure absolute control over data entry.

Field Observation: The user completely ignored the voice input/microphone icon. For him, voice UI in banking isn't a convenient shortcut; it is an active security threat.

— Observed in a 66 y.o. male user from Mumbai. Preference for manual typing over voice was also explicitly cited by another User.



USERS REJECTING THE VOICE TOOL IN FAVOR OF MANUALLY TYPING ACCOUNT NUMBERS FOR SECURITY.

Task 2B

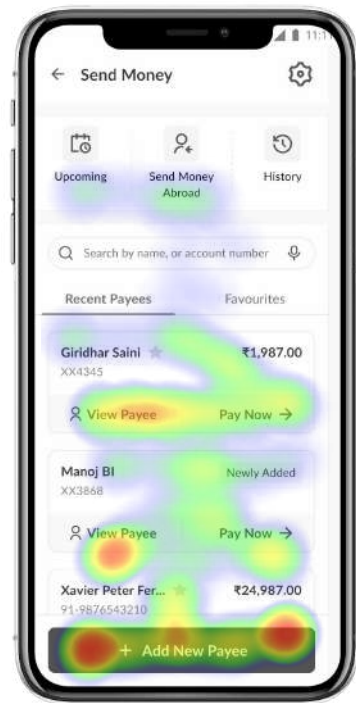
Search Discoverability Depends on Digital Familiarity

The global search bar is essentially invisible to seniors unless they have pre-existing digital fluency from modern retail apps.

- Most default to scrolling all the way to the bottom to find a concrete, explicit list of payees rather than trusting a search query.

Field Observation: The user completely missed the global Search bar at the top of the screen. His immediate instinct was to scroll all the way to the bottom to find a "View All Payees" button.

— Observed in a 66 y.o. male user from Mumbai. 2 other Users also struggled to locate or use the search bar. Conversely, one User successfully used it by explicitly relying on muscle memory learned from Amazon.



USERS IGNORING THE TOP SEARCH BAR TO PHYSICALLY SCROLL FOR RECENT PAYEES.

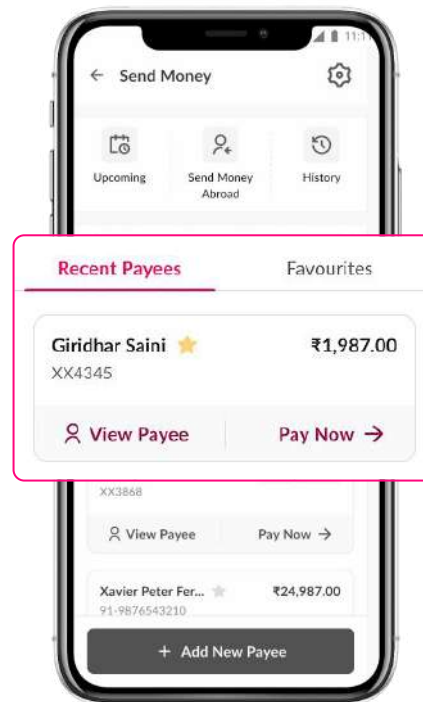
Users Can Misinterpret Actions When Terminology Is Unfamiliar

Small differences in how actions are worded can create major task friction.

- Users do not inherently understand the semantic difference between “viewing a payee” and executing a payment when both are presented as actionable text links next to a name.

Field Observation: She successfully used the Search bar to find the payee, but then tapped “View Payee” instead of “Pay Now.” The semantic difference between viewing and acting was not clear to her.

— Observed in a 60 y.o. female user from Patna. Another user exhibited the exact same confusion, simply because it was the first actionable text he saw.



THE AMBIGUOUS WORDING OF "VIEW PAYEE" VERSUS "PAY NOW" CAUSING TASK FRICTION.

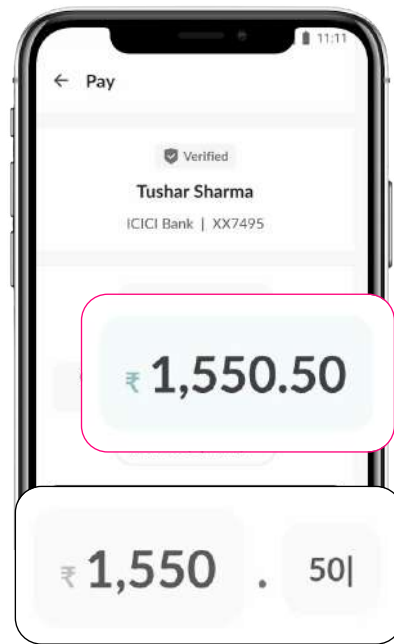
Splitting Amounts Can Add Unnecessary Complexity

Attempting to prevent decimal entry errors by physically splitting the UI into "Rupees" and "Paise" boxes is heavily criticized by most users.

- Financial input was the highest-anxiety moment; users strongly preferred a standard single-field input that matched their ingrained mental model.
- It breaks standard banking input conventions and introduces unnecessary complexity, though it holds niche appeal for a minority.

Field Observation: He heavily criticized the split-decimal UI, asking why it was necessary and finding it more confusing than a standard input field.

— Observed in a 70 y.o. male user from Badlapur. Notably, one user (60 y.o. male from Mumbai) was the sole participant who genuinely preferred it, citing clear visual distinction.



PREFERRED
(SINGLE INPUT FIELD)

CRITICIZED
(SPLIT-DECIMAL)

INPUT FIELD DURING PAYMENT

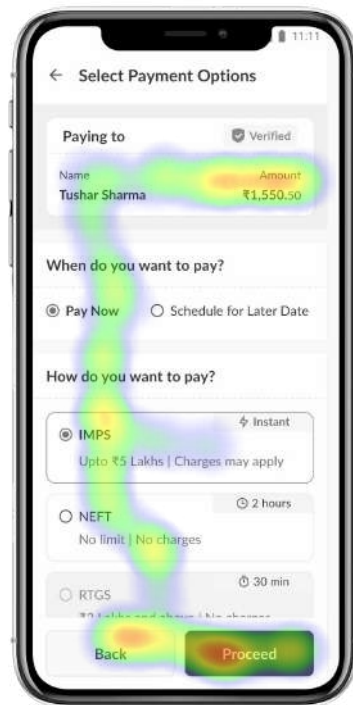
Users Focus on the Amount Before Other Transaction Details

When users reach the final review screen, their cognitive focus narrows almost exclusively to the final transaction amount.

- While a minority of highly financially literate users might actively hunt for payment modes to avoid fees, the vast majority completely ignore scheduling options and routing methods.
- The amount is the undisputed visual and cognitive anchor.

Field Observation: On the review screen, she hyper-focused exclusively on the total amount and completely ignored the payment modes (NEFT/RTGS) and scheduling options below it.

— Observed in a 60 y.o. female user from Patna. (The exception being one user, who explicitly checked for NEFT to avoid IMPS charges).



USERS FIXATING ENTIRELY ON THE FINAL TRANSACTION AMOUNT WHILE IGNORING ROUTING OPTIONS.

Task 3

- **Scenario**
Enable transaction approval in Family Settings, select an approver, set a limit and attempt payment above the limit
- **Objective**
Test approver setup discoverability, 3-step setup clarity, and real-time warning/approval trigger comprehension.
- **Observe**
Ease of finding Family Settings, limit selection, and reaction to the approval step during payment.

Task 3A

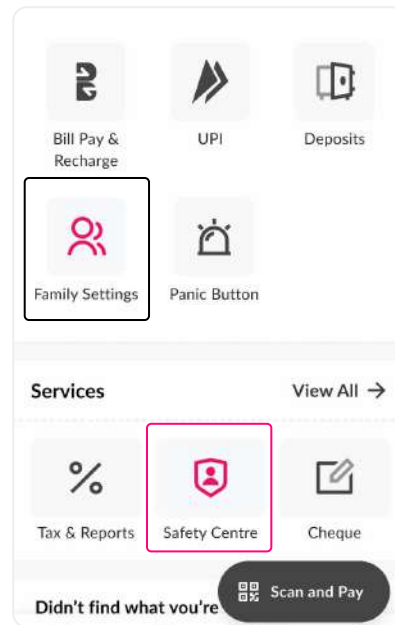
Users Look for Security Features Under Safety-Related Labels

The Information Architecture is fighting the users' natural instincts. When tasked with setting up a "safeguard," users immediately hunt for literal security keywords.

- They bypass, relationship-based terms like "Family Settings" and map their need directly to explicit safety nomenclature.

Field Observation: When asked to set up a safeguard, he completely bypassed "Family Settings" and tapped the "Panic Button" instead. Navigation was driven by literal, 1-to-1 keyword matching rather than abstract mental models.

— Observed in a 66 y.o. male user from Mumbai. Searching for safety-specific labels was the dominant behavior, also noted explicitly in 4 other users.



USERS INTUITIVELY HUNTING FOR SAFEGUARDS UNDER "SAFETY CENTRE" RATHER THAN "FAMILY SETTINGS."

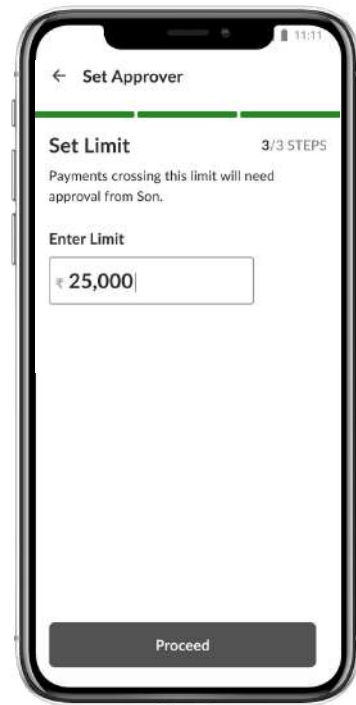
Users Interpret Approval Limits as Spending Limits

The core concept of a "Maker-Checker" workflow partially fails to translate.

- The vast majority of users do not understand that a transaction sits in a pending state awaiting a third party's physical approval.
- Instead, they map this feature to traditional banking mechanics: a self-imposed lock, a hard daily transfer limit, or a spending cap.

Field Observation: He partly misunderstood the feature's mechanism. He thought the limit was there simply so he wouldn't accidentally send extra money, missing the point that a third party actually has to approve the transaction.

— Observed in an 81 y.o. male user from Gurgaon. This misunderstanding was shared by 4 users, including another User, who concluded it simply meant she could not pay above the limit.



SETTING THE TRANSACTION LIMIT, FREQUENTLY MISINTERPRETED AS A HARD SPENDING CAP.

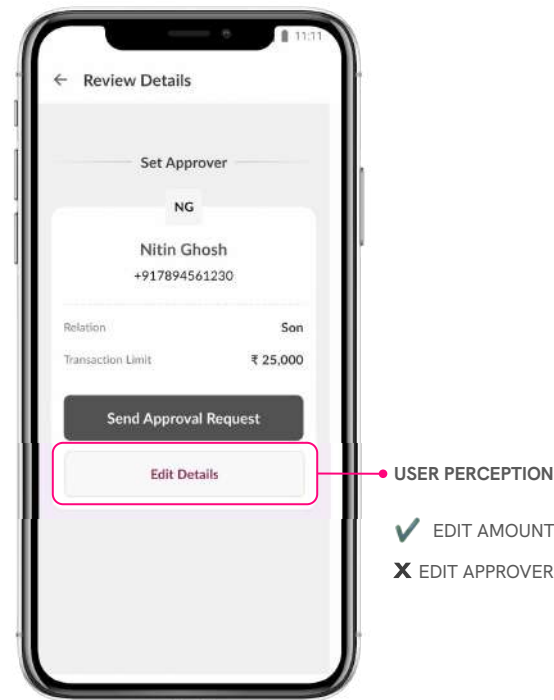
Users' Mental Model Does Not Extend to Approver Management

Because users view this entirely as a financial limit tool rather than a relationship-management tool, their mental model does not extend to approver management.

- They understand that they can adjust the money, but changing the person assigned to the rule does not intuitively occur to them.

Field Observation: After setup, he understood he could go back to change the amount limit, but it didn't occur to him that he could also change the approver (the person). He views this strictly as a financial limit tool.

— Observed in a 64 y.o. male user from Mumbai (User 2). This limitation in the mental model was observed in 2 users.



THE REVIEW SCREEN WHERE USERS FAIL TO REALIZE THEY CAN CHANGE THE ASSIGNED PERSON.

Task 3B

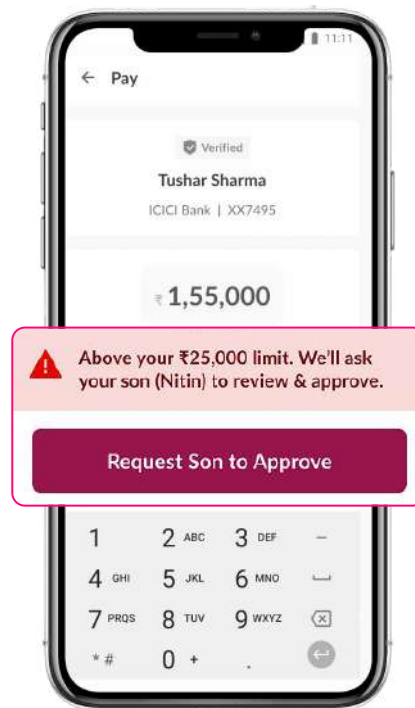
Verification Adds Confidence to High-Value Payments

Additional verification shows an increase in confidence in high-value transactions. For senior users transferring large sums, friction is highly celebrated.

- Users explicitly cite a fear of making manual entry errors, like accidentally adding an extra zero.
- The "Request to Approve" barrier acts as a welcome safety net that directly alleviates this anxiety, making them feel protected rather than restricted.

Field Observation: His reaction was highly positive. He specifically mentioned forgetting things and making typing errors, making this feature a critical and welcome safety measure.

— Observed in a 70 y.o. male user from Badlapur. This increase in confidence was noted across 7 users



THE MAKER-CHECKER LIMIT SUCCESSFULLY
RELIEVING "TYPO ANXIETY" ON LARGE TRANSFERS.

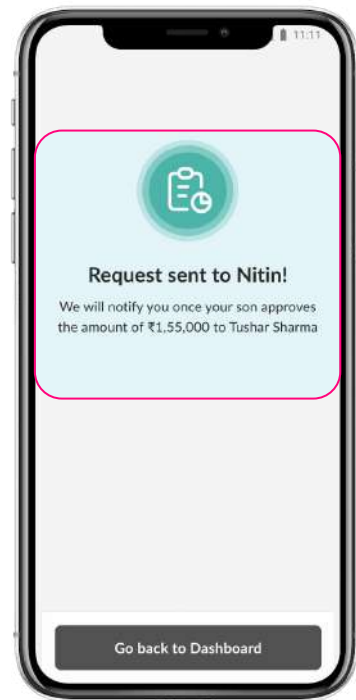
Offline Habits Continue to Shape Digital Behaviour

Familiar offline behaviors shape how users approach the workflow.

- Seniors do not view this digital workflow in isolation; they conceptually map this feature to the existing, familiar habit of calling a relative to ask for a card OTP.
- Multiple users state they would proactively call or speak to their family member to inform them that a request was coming.

Field Observation: He noted that he would proactively inform his daughter beforehand so she would expect the SMS request, directly mirroring how he currently handles physical OTPs.

— Observed in a 60 y.o. male user from Mumbai. This bridge between digital prompts and physical phone calls was observed in 4 users.



THE REQUEST SENT SCREEN (INDIRECTLY) PROMPTING USERS TO PHYSICALLY CALL THEIR APPROVER.

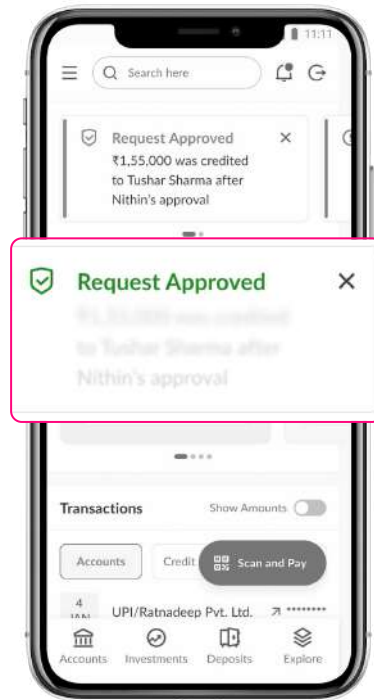
Users Are Unclear About Post-Approval Actions

Users are uncertain whether approval completes the transaction. While the initiation of the request is perfectly understood, the system's behavior after the approval is ambiguous.

- There is a severe drop-off in reading UI copy once the initial request is sent.
- Some assume they have to manually execute the payment again, while others completely miss the dashboard notifications confirming the transaction.

Field Observation: He failed to understand the auto-credit flow. He assumed he would have to manually "pay" once his son approved it.

— Observed in a 64 y.o. male user from Mumbai. Another user completely missed the post-approval dashboard notification entirely. This ambiguity affected 4 users.



THE SUBTLE SUCCESS NOTIFICATION THAT LEAVES USERS UNSURE IF THE MONEY WAS ACTUALLY SENT.

Task 4

- **Scenario**
Scan the landing screen to find a specific service, then explore greyed-out products to try enabling one.
- **Objective**
Test icon density perception (~50 vs ~10 icons A/B) and restricted feature / enablement flow comprehension.
- **Observe**
Search friction on high-density icons, discovery of View All, and reaction to locked feature prompts.

Task 4A

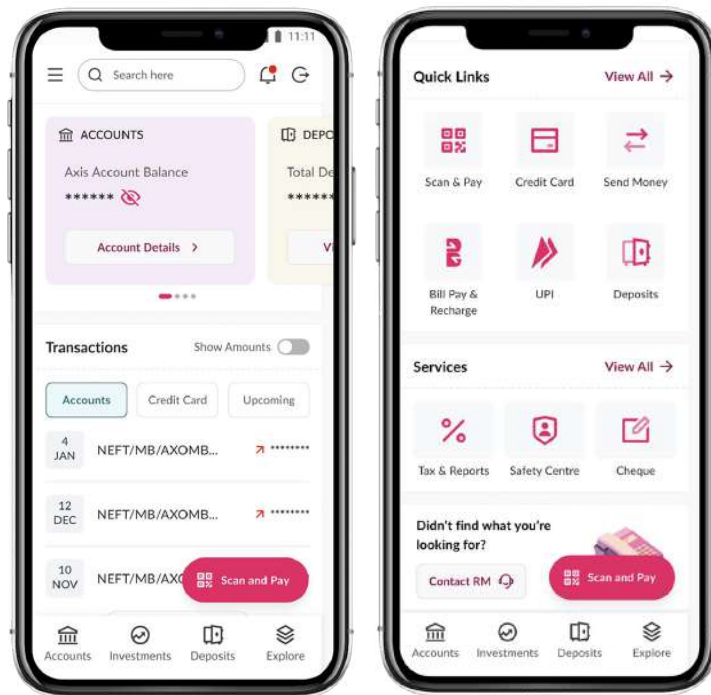
Users Prefer Simplicity, Even When It Takes Longer

Reduced visual complexity can increase interaction time. Seniors overwhelmingly prefer the visual design of the Senior Dashboard (Easy Mode), using words like "clean" and "less crowded."

- However, because this simpler UI hides secondary features behind "Explore" menus, users actually take longer to complete tasks.
- They are willing to trade speed and immediate feature discovery for larger text and reduced visual anxiety.

Field Observation: He struggled heavily with locating items and did not even imagine that tools could be located in a bottom Navigation Bar. However, he still strongly preferred the new layout, citing "easier to read and bigger, less information,".

— Observed in a 70 y.o. male user from Badlapur. This willing trade-off was noted across 5 users.



USERS NAVIGATING THE DENSE ICON GRID, PREFERRED VISUAL SIMPLICITY DESPITE LONGER TASK TIMES.

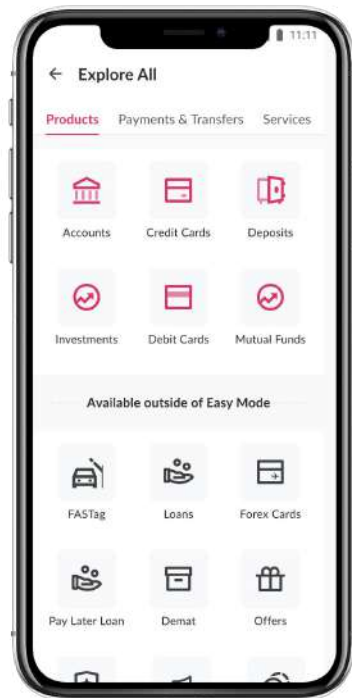
Users Assume Visible Features Are Available

Visual cues for unavailable features are not clear. The universal UI convention that a greyed-out icon means "disabled" completely fails with senior users.

- They misinterpret grey icons as purely aesthetic, a "less frequently used" category, or assume everything on the screen is fully clickable.
- Showing disabled features causes high friction; if they cannot use it in this mode, it should not be visible.

Field Observation: He did not naturally recognise the grey icons as disabled, instead interpreting the colour as a visual design choice rather than a functional state.

— Observed in a 64 y.o. male user from Mumbai. One user thought they meant "frequently used," and other assumed all grey icons were fully available. This failure was noted across 5 users.



GRAYED-OUT ICONS FALSELY ASSUMED TO BE AESTHETIC CHOICES OR FULLY AVAILABLE FEATURES.

Users Scan Vertically, Not Across Tabs

Tab-based navigation does not match users' scanning behavior.

- When navigating the Explore screen, seniors do not naturally look at top-level horizontal category tabs.
- Their eyes lock onto the center grid of icons, and their physical instinct is to scroll vertically down the page.

Field Observation: She completely missed the category tabs (Products, Payments, Services) at the top of the screen, relying entirely on vertical scrolling.

— Observed in a 60 y.o. female user from Mumbai. Ignoring horizontal tab navigation was observed in 5 users.



USERS SCROLLING DOWN THE GRID AND ENTIRELY MISSING THE TOP HORIZONTAL CATEGORY TABS.

Task 4B

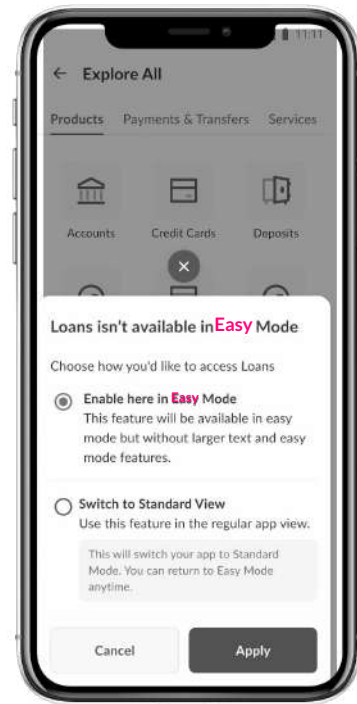
Users Respond to the Label Before Understanding the Mode

Users respond to the label before understanding the mode. When forced to choose between "Enable in Easy Mode" and "Switch to Standard View," the cohort overwhelmingly gravitates toward Easy Mode.

- However, this is driven by literal keyword anchoring: they select the option with the word "Easy" simply because they want the task to be easy, regardless of the structural IA difference.
- Helper text (mentioning larger fonts) successfully bridges the gap for some.

Field Observation: He chose "Enable here in Easy Mode" purely because of the word "Easy," assuming it meant the process itself would be easier to operate.

— Observed in a 70 y.o. male user from Badlapur. This keyword anchoring was noted across 5 users.



USERS SELECTING "ENABLE IN EASY MODE" PURELY BECAUSE OF THE WORD "EASY."

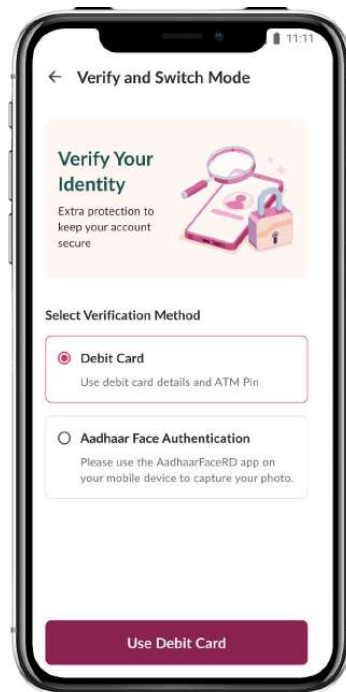
Users Don't Expect Identity Checks for Settings

Authentication creates friction when the action is non-financial.

- Requiring hardcore authentication (Debit Card/Aadhaar) to make a disabled UI icon active introduces severe logical friction.
- Users question why identity verification is needed just to customize the screen, with some actively distrusting the use of Aadhaar infrastructure for a UI setting.

Field Observation: While he understood the verification was to confirm his identity, he questioned its necessity, viewing it as an unnecessary hurdle just to turn on a UI feature. Another user was completely baffled by the Aadhaar option, asking "why AADHAR? for KYC?"

— Observed in a 60 y.o. male user from Mumbai and a 70 y.o. male user from Badlapur. This pushback was noted across 3 users.



THE UNEXPECTED AADHAAR AND DEBIT CARD AUTHENTICATION WALL CAUSING FRICTION FOR UI CHANGES.

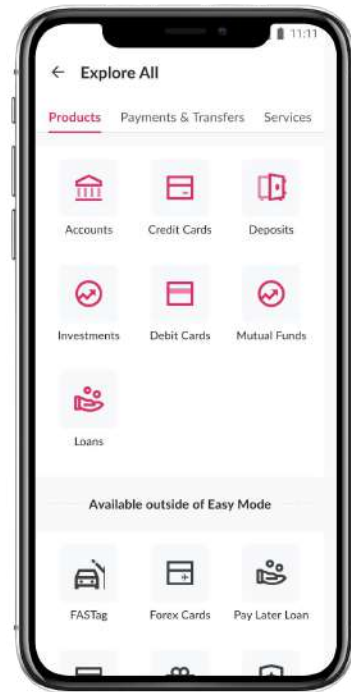
Users Need Stronger Visual Feedback After an Action

Users struggle to notice subtle changes in UI state. The visual payoff for completing this flow completely fails.

- Moving an icon from the bottom grey section to the top pink section is far too subtle a change for this demographic.
- If the UI changes state, it needs a massive, unmistakable focal point or an unmistakable success animation.

Field Observation: Despite successfully enabling the feature, he completely missed the visual UI change on the screen (the icon turning pink and moving to the top). Another user stared directly at the updated screen and stated it "looks the same."

— Observed in a 64 y.o. male user from Mumbai and a 64 y.o. female user from Mumbai. This failure to notice state changes affected 4 users.



THE UNNOTICEABLE VISUAL SHIFT FROM A GRAY DISABLED ICON TO A PINK ACTIVE ONE.

Task 5

- **Scenario**
Switch between Easy Mode and Standard Mode before and after login.
- **Objective**
Evaluate mode discoverability, comprehension, and switching confidence.
- **Observe**
Discovery, navigation path, task completion, and need for assistance.

Task 5A

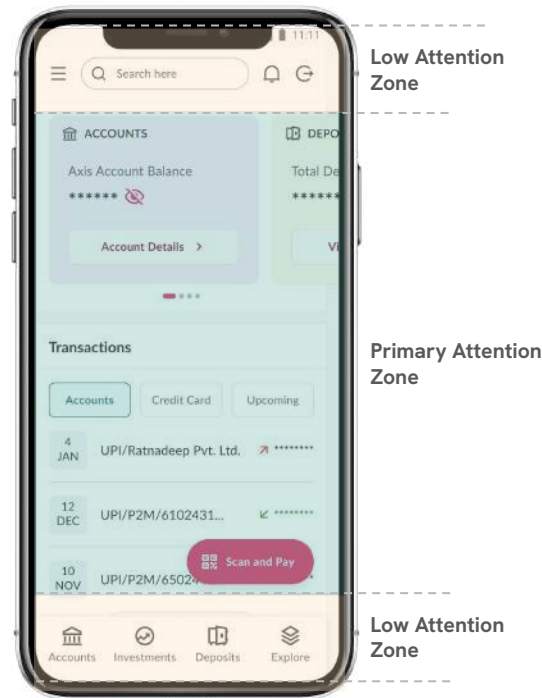
Users Don't Expect Mode Switching in the Hamburger Menu

Users look for mode switching on the main dashboard; the hamburger menu is not a natural path for them. Not a single user naturally went to the hamburger menu as their first instinct to switch modes.

- Users expect structural mode changes to be surfaced directly on the main dashboard as an explicit button.
- The hamburger menu is viewed as a place for less frequently used settings, not a primary interaction point.

Field Observation: She searched the dashboard, checked Quick Links, and dug into "View All" before finally checking the hamburger menu as a last resort. Another user looked under "Explore" and eventually clicked "Contact RM" because she hit a dead end.

— Observed in a 60 y.o. female user from Mumbai and a 60 y.o. female user from Patna . This complete bypass of the hamburger menu was noted across 7 users.



USER ATTENTION FOCUSED PURELY ON THE DASHBOARD, COMPLETELY BYPASSING THE HIDDEN MENU FOR MODE SWITCHING.

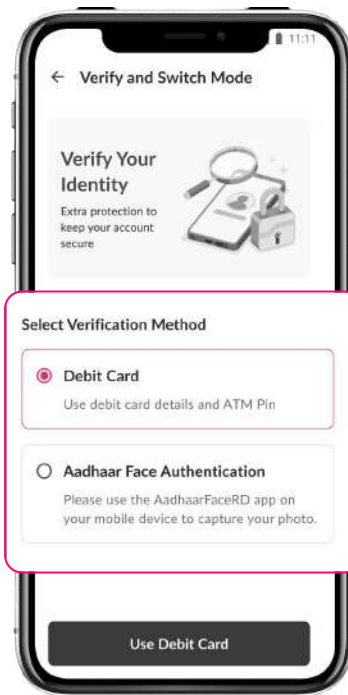
Bank-Controlled Authentication Feels More Reliable

Users prefer bank-controlled authentication over Aadhaar. When forced to authenticate, seniors overwhelmingly reject Aadhaar in favor of Debit Cards.

- This is rarely about privacy; it is almost entirely about infrastructure reliability (Aadhaar systems crashing) and a critical mental model of accountability: a debit card is issued by the bank, so if something goes wrong, the bank is accountable.

Field Observation: He definitively rejected Aadhaar in favor of the Debit Card, providing a highly logical reason: **"Debit is issued by bank so if something goes wrong, the bank is accountable.** Aadhaar is a third-party thing." Another user explicitly stated, "AADHAR is useless most of the time."

— Observed in a 70 y.o. male user from Badlapur and a 60 y.o. female user from Mumbai. This preference was noted across 4 users.



PREFERENCE FOR AUTHENTICATION

Task 5B

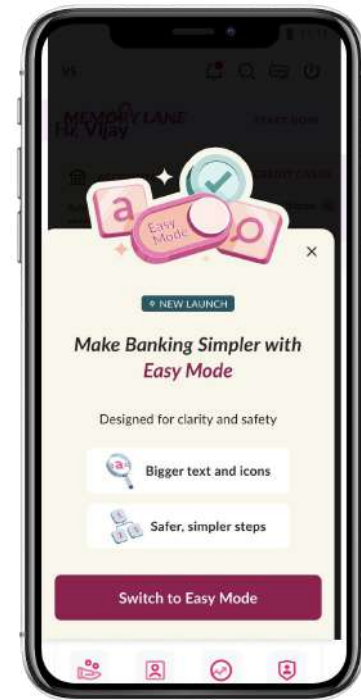
Users Understand Easy Mode When It's Explained Early

Early explanation improves understanding of new concepts. When "Easy Mode" is introduced at the pre-login stage with clear supporting copy, comprehension hits 100%.

- Users do not hesitate or ask questions when the value proposition is presented upfront before they enter the app ecosystem.

Field Observation: The Easy Mode introduction pop-up was completely clear to her without any additional guidance from the moderator. Once switched, she actively noted that the new login screen was easier to understand than the standard version.

— Observed in a 60 y.o. female user from Patna. This immediate comprehension was noted across 6 users, with one user explicitly noting that the introductory screen provided all the context needed to make a decision.



THE HIGHLY SUCCESSFUL EASY MODE ONBOARDING PROMPT THAT YIELDS 100% COMPREHENSION.

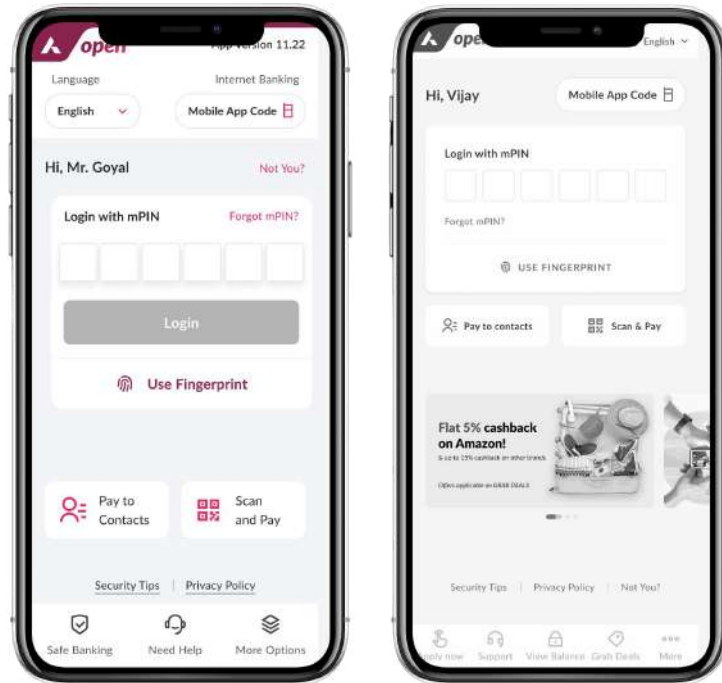
Users Trust What They Enter Themselves

Manual authentication is preferred over biometric alternatives. Despite modern apps pushing fingerprint and face ID as the most frictionless login methods, seniors overwhelmingly prefer manual MPIN entry.

- They feel more in control when manually inputting a code they have memorized (in spite of a few mentioning they make errors entering it).

Field Observation: His immediate preference was to use his MPIN rather than Fingerprint biometrics to log in.

— Observed in a 66 y.o. male user from Mumbai. This strict preference for manual MPIN entry was observed in 5 users. (A 64 y.o. female, was the sole exception who preferred fingerprint).



(Clear Winner)

THE EXPLICIT PREFERENCE FOR TYPING AN MPIN OVER USING BIOMETRIC FINGERPRINT LOGINS.

Task 6

- **Scenario**
Select your preferred language/mode while onboarding and evaluate UPI dashboard wireframe.
- **Objective**
Test language/easy-mode selection comprehension, UPI dashboard feature discoverability.
- **Observe**
Ease of switching languages, route choice (UPI vs. Scan & Pay), and rationale behind their preferred method.

Task 6A

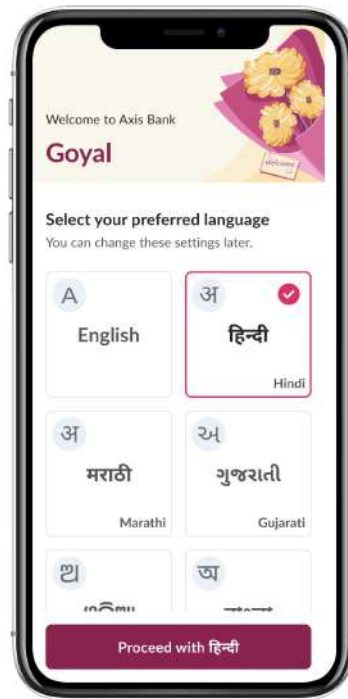
Users Expect a Fully Translated Experience

Users expect consistent language throughout the experience, but they are skeptical. While users expect a 100% translated experience when they select a regional language, they do not actually trust that the app will deliver it.

- Seniors who rely on vernacular languages carry residual frustration from other digital products where localization is incomplete.
- If regional languages are offered, the execution must be flawless, or it erodes trust immediately.

Field Observation: He spotted his preferred language (Tamil) and expected the app to completely adapt to it, but immediately expressed deep skepticism born from past experiences: "If I selected Tamil.. it would be completely Tamil... but will it happen.. most times it is not fully functional."

— Observed in a 64 y.o. male user from Mumbai. One user also expected a 100% language experience but found his native Urdu missing entirely.



POSSIBILITY OF THE VERNACULAR SELECTION SCREEN TRIGGERING DISTRUST BASED ON PAST POOR TRANSLATION EXPERIENCES.

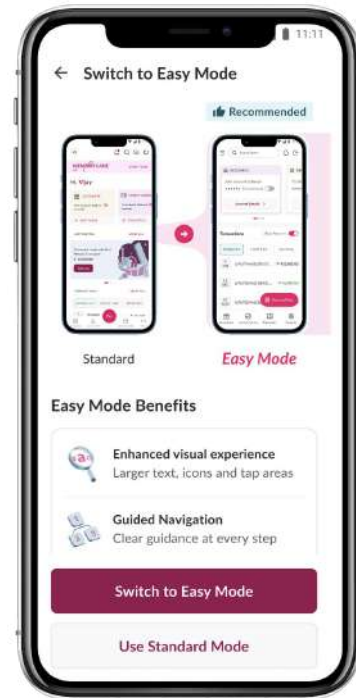
Knowing It's Reversible Makes the Choice Easier for Users

Users are more confident when choices can be changed later.

- Not a single user felt trapped by the choice to enter Easy Mode during onboarding.
- Because they inherently understand (or have just been taught) that system settings can be modified later, they treat this as a low-stakes preference rather than a permanent lock-in.

Field Observation: When asked if he felt locked into this choice, he confidently stated he knew it could be changed later. Having experienced the mode toggle in the hamburger menu previously, he now possessed the mental model that this setting is reversible, eliminating any onboarding anxiety.

— Observed in a 66 y.o. male user from Mumbai. One user also explicitly referenced her previous learning to confirm the choice was reversible. This lack of anxiety was noted across 5 users.



THE EASY MODE SWITCH SCREEN SUCCEEDING BECAUSE USERS KNOW THEY ARE NOT PERMANENTLY LOCKED IN.

Task 6B

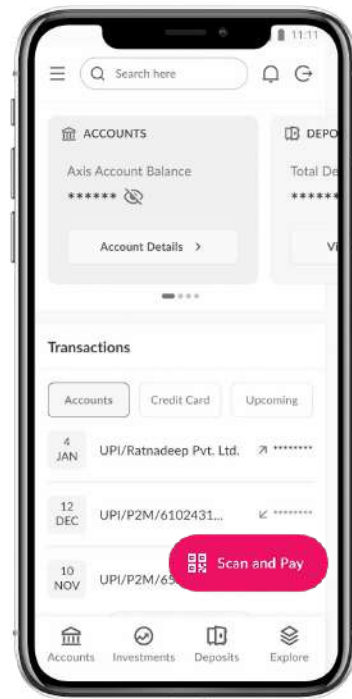
Familiar Actions Shape How Seniors Approach UPI Payments

"Scan & Pay" is the most familiar entry point for any kind of UPI payment or transfer. The cohort overwhelmingly anchors to "Scan & Pay" as the definitive starting point for digital transfers.

- The physical action of scanning QR codes has become deeply ingrained as synonymous with UPI payments for this demographic, overriding other navigational paths.

Field Observation: Her immediate first choice to initiate a payment was "Scan & Pay." She bypassed searching for saved names entirely, preferring the explicit action buttons for scanning or entering a UPI ID.

— Observed in a 64 y.o. female user from Mumbai. This strict anchor to "Scan & Pay" was explicitly noted across 4 users.



USERS HEAVILY ANCHORING TO THE QR SCAN BUTTON AS THE DEFINITIVE STARTING POINT FOR DIGITAL PAYMENTS.

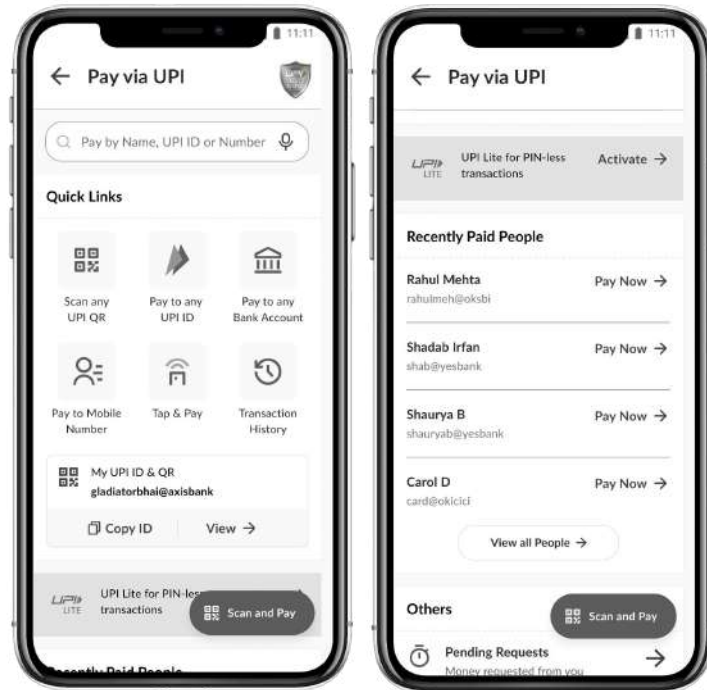
Familiarity With UPI Patterns Reduces Navigation Effort

Familiar UPI patterns make the experience frictionless to navigate.

- The standard UPI mental model is so well-established in the market that adhering to conventional UI patterns results in zero friction for senior users.
- If the architecture mimics what they already know, they do not struggle.

Field Observation: His mental model of the UPI ecosystem is perfectly aligned with other payment apps. He explicitly compared the screen to Google Pay and found the screen "Easy" to digest.

— Observed in a 66 y.o. male user from Mumbai. Across the board, every single user described navigating this wireframe as "Easy" or "Very Easy."



STANDARDIZED UPI LAYOUTS ELIMINATING NAVIGATION FRICTION.

Users Value Clarity, Familiarity and a Sense of Control

Visuals Win, Navigation Can be Better: Every user praised the visual simplicity (larger text, less clutter), but struggled with standard navigation mechanics (invisible hamburger menus, confusing disabled icons).

Safety Overcomes Friction: Users love the psychological safety of the Maker-Checker limit, even if the novelty of the feature causes initial setup friction.

High Forgiveness: Seniors are surprisingly forgiving. They consistently rated the app 4/5 or 5/5 because the core value of an easier, safer banking experience heavily outweighs the learning curve.

Too Confusing



Very Easy

4.3

"Very good for someone like me... this helps a lot."

- 64 y.o. User, Mumbai

"Mostly easy... nothing difficult here."

- 60 y.o. User, Mumbai

"Very good, very easy."

- 81 y.o. User, Gurgaon

"Will take time to build habit, but was very good and easy to read"

- 70 y.o. User, Mumbai

Research Recommendations

Bringing the Easy Mode Toggle to the Dashboard

- **Observation:** While users easily understand Easy Mode when it is presented pre-login, 7 users completely bypassed the hamburger menu when trying to switch modes from inside the app.
- **Recommendation:** To make switching modes more intuitive post-login, we might consider placing the Easy Mode toggle directly on the main dashboard. Bringing it out of the hidden navigation menu could drastically reduce the friction of finding it.

Hiding Unsupported Features Instead of Disabling Them

- **Observation:** Grayed-out icons (like “Loans”) were often misinterpreted as aesthetic choices or errors rather than unavailable features, creating confusion during authentication. Once activated, the change in icon state was also not easily recognizable to users.
- **Recommendation:** It might be worth presenting state changes in ways that align with seniors’ mental models and everyday visual cues. Using clear, familiar, and noticeable visual treatments to distinguish inactive from active features, so users can immediately recognize when something has become available or changed would be important for improving discoverability and reducing confusion.

Framing Approvals Around Familiar Offline Analogies

- **Observation:** Users loved the safety net of the Maker-Checker limit, but they naturally hunted for it under "Safety Center" or the "Panic Button" rather than "Family Settings." Additionally, many were unsure if the payment would execute automatically after the approver said yes.
- **Recommendation:** To make discoverability intuitive, it might be worth renaming the module to explicitly state its purpose to something that matches their mental model. To clear up the post-approval confusion, we could state the automation explicitly *before* the request is sent (e.g., adding a simple note on the request screen: "Once approved, the payment will complete automatically. No further action needed.").

Utilizing Bank-Issued Methods for Security Checks

- **Observation:** Seniors actively distrust Aadhaar infrastructure for UI changes and prefer manual MPINs over biometrics.
- **Recommendation:** For actions requiring security friction, relying on bank-native authentication like Debit Card verification or manual MPINs seems to build more trust. Framing these checks around bank accountability rather than third-party or device-level infrastructure could help alleviate user skepticism.

Executive Summary

Visuals & Navigation

- A "less is more" UI drastically reduces cognitive load; users universally rate the app highly (4.3/5) despite mechanical struggles.
- Hamburger menus, horizontal category tabs, and grayed-out "disabled" icons are functionally invisible or misinterpreted by this demographic.
- Seniors aim for large, explicit areas (entire tiles or text blocks) and completely overlook small, isolated icons or toggles.

Trust & Security

- The Maker-Checker approval flow and high-value caution prompts are celebrated as vital safety nets against "typo anxiety."
- Users actively reject Aadhaar in favor of Debit Cards, trusting bank-issued infrastructure over third-party systems.
- Explicit, manual actions (MPINs, direct Search bars) are heavily preferred over frictionless tech (Biometrics, algorithmic "Recent Payee" carousels).

Mental Models & Terminology

- Users conceptually map digital workflows (like the Approval request) to familiar offline habits (calling a relative for an OTP).
- The concept of switching between "Easy" and "Standard" mode does not exist in their mental model; they view apps as static environments.
- When faced with dense or confusing UI, seniors blame their own lack of technical skill or "learning curve" rather than criticizing the design.

Onboarding & Context

- Introducing new concepts (Easy Mode) during pre-login or onboarding with explicit bullet points yields 100% comprehension.
- Explicitly showing users that settings can be changed later completely removes the hesitation of making a "wrong" choice during setup.
- Users expect a 100% translated experience when selecting a regional language, but carry deep skepticism that the app will actually deliver it flawlessly.



Thank You